

module-03-ayurveda-good-health - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - senior band

Module 3 — Āyurveda and Good Health (Darśana)

Sanskrit: Āyurveda · **Band:** Senior (9-12) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

The science of life — daily routine, diet, and well-being.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 3's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

“Modern medicine is reactive — you go when something is wrong. Āyurveda is preventive — you live so that things don't go wrong. Today we examine the framework: dinacharya (daily routine), ahāra (diet), and tridoṣa (the three constitutional types). All as wellness lens — NOT diagnosis.”

Core idea · 15 min

Āyurveda as Indian preventive medicine.

1. **Dinacarya** (daily routine, codified in Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, Sūtrasthāna 2). Sleep, wake, food, exercise, elimination — each at appropriate time. Modern: circadian biology shows ~85% of human physiology has circadian rhythm. Misalignment correlates with metabolic and cognitive impairment.
2. **Ahāra** (diet, Sūtrasthāna 5). The six tastes (ṣaḍ-rasa) — each meal should ideally include several. Sweet alone (modern diet) is the most common modern misalignment. *Ṛtucharya* (seasonal eating) — light and bitter in summer (pitta-rich), warm and oily in winter (vāta-rich).
3. **Tridoṣa** (Caraka Sūtrasthāna 1.57). *Prakṛti* (innate constitution) vs *vikṛti* (current state). Self-knowledge as the first step of self-care.

CRITICAL CAVEAT, REPEATED: this is a wellness lens, NOT a diagnostic system. For health concerns, see a doctor.

Demonstration · 10 min

Source-text reading. Read aloud Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, *Sūtrasthāna* 2.1–5 (a brief stanza on dinacarya). Discuss: how much of this is *empirical* (testable by modern science), how much is *prescriptive* (a values judgment), how much is *symbolic* (cultural-religious framing).

Source moment · 5 min

Quoted verse. Caraka Saṁhitā, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.41:

prayojanaṁ ca asya svastha-svāsthya-rakṣaṇam āturyasya vikāra-prāśamaṇam ca

“The purpose of this is the preservation of health in the healthy AND the alleviation of disorders in the diseased.”

Note the syntactic priority: *svastha-svāsthya-rakṣaṇam* (healthy-people’s-health-preservation) comes FIRST. The discipline is fundamentally preventive.

Hands-on activity · 15 min

One-week dinacarya self-audit. Each student logs their actual sleep/wake/food times for ONE typical week (or recalls last week). Identify 2 misalignments with Āyurveda recommendations. Propose ONE specific change to test for 2 weeks. Honest reflection: “*What’s preventing me from making this change?*”

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

“*Āyurveda articulates a wellness framework. Modern medicine articulates a disease framework. Argue: which framework does our society currently OVER-prioritise? Which is UNDER-prioritised? What would balanced integration look like?*”

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — What is Āyurveda? Definition + scope
- **Day 02** — Tridoṣa — vāta, pitta, kapha
- **Day 03** — Dinacarya — daily routine
- **Day 04** — Ahāra — food + the six tastes
- **Day 05** — Ṛtucarya — seasonal eating
- **Day 06** — Sleep, exercise, elimination

- **Day 07** — Caraka, Suśruta, Vāgbhaṭa — the three Āyurveda authors
- **Day 08** — Bridge to modern science — circadian, microbiome
- **Day 09** — Critical reading — Āyurveda claims vs evidence
- **Day 10** — Synthesis: personal wellness plan + class share

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.